Naughty Harry, eh? Hooray Harry.

I felt a mix of complicated emotions about saying goodbye to Afghanistan, but I couldn't wait to say goodbye to this chap.

First, I flew with my squadron to Cyprus, for what the Army called "decompression." I hadn't had any mandated decompression after my last tour, so I was excited, though not as much as my bodyguards. *Finally! We can have a bloody cold beer!*

Everyone was issued exactly two cans. No more. I didn't like beer, so I handed mine over to a soldier who looked like he needed it more than me. He reacted as if I'd given him a Rolex.

We were then taken to a comedy show. Attendance was quasi-mandatory. Whoever organized it had had good intentions: a bit of levity after a tour of hell. And, to be fair, some of us did laugh. But most didn't. We were struggling and didn't know we were struggling. We had memories to process, mental wounds to heal, existential questions to sort. (We'd been told that a padre was available if we needed to talk, but I remember no one going near him.) So we just sat at the comedy show in the same way we'd sat in the VHR tent. In a state of suspended animation. Waiting.

I felt bad for those comedians. One tough gig.

Before we left Cyprus someone told me I was all over the papers.

Oh yeah?

The interview.

Shit. I'd completely forgotten.

Apparently I'd caused quite a stir by admitting that I'd killed people. In a war.

I was criticized up and down for being…a killer?

And being blithe about it.

I'd mentioned, in passing, that the Apache controls were reminiscent of video-game controls. And thus:

Harry compares killing to video game!

I threw down the paper. Where was that padre?